

Foreword

The ability to speak and write well is essential for good communication in everyday life and in school. Our messages—whether spoken or written—need to be clear and easy for others to understand. While the importance of proper speaking and writing skills is often lost in our world of texting, e-mailing, and instant messaging, these skills are very important. Good speaking and writing skills help get a message across clearly and accurately, and give it credibility. Writing that is riddled with errors of grammar, punctuation, and spelling will reflect poorly on the writer, even if he or she is very knowledgeable about a topic. A good command of the English language and basic communication skills can lead to better grades in school and give a student a clear advantage over someone who is less skilled in language usage.

The rules of grammar, punctuation, and spelling, and the skills needed to communicate effectively can be bewildering. That’s why *Help Your Kids with Language Arts* is an essential resource. This book presents examples that help to make the rules of grammar, punctuation, spelling, and communication clear and accessible. Wondering whether to say “you and me” or “you and I”? This book will provide an easy-to-understand explanation.

This book sets out to explain in simple terms the rules of clear and effective speaking and writing. It is divided into four chapters that focus on the key English language arts topics: grammar, punctuation, spelling, and communication skills. The information within each chapter is designed to make these English language arts interesting and enjoyable to learn. Engaging examples supported by step-by-step, simple-to-follow explanations will make even the most confusing concepts easy to grasp. This book will equip parents with the information they need to help students develop the skills required to communicate effectively in both speaking and writing.

As a former teacher, I am very aware of the importance of good communication skills. Success in school and in life is enhanced by these skills. *Help Your Kids with Language Arts* is an essential resource because throughout life we refine our use of the English language—always striving for clear and accurate communication with others.

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